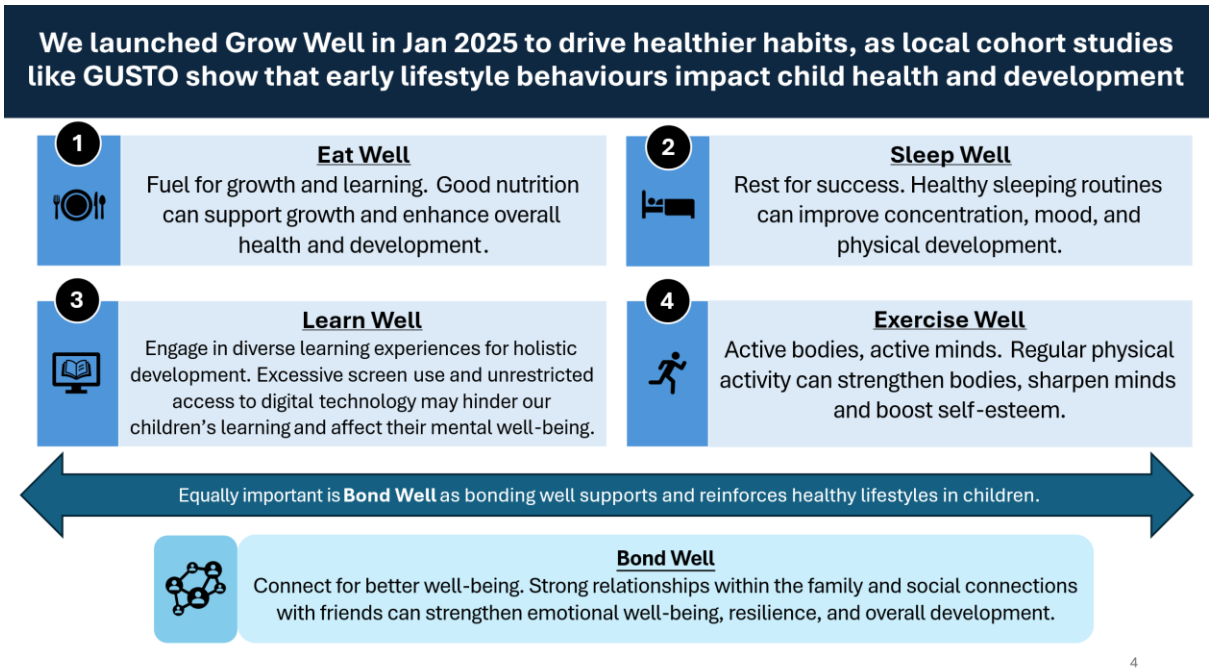
HPB Grow Well SG (GWSG) Message House FGD Guide – Parents (Phase 3)

Background:

The Grow Well SG (GWSG) Message House was developed in 2025 to provide a consistent set of health messages and CTAs across Whole-of-Government stakeholders.



- PM National Day Rally Speech 2025
  "…..The reality is we are living in a digital age. There are huge upsides to being digitally connected- greater access to knowledge, more avenues to express ourselves and new ways to connect with one another. So we must make full use of these technologies. But we must also be clear-eyed about the downsides, and manage them carefully. And that means striking the right balance. A balance between protecting our young from the potential harms. And equipping and empowering them to fully exploit the benefits of technology.

  And we have to start early- right from infancy. For infants and toddlers, the science is clear: no screen time at all. Even for preschoolers, we should be mindful and limit their screen time,. That means we should not use phones as a baby-sitter- just to keep our children quiet or occupied. Instead we should encourage them to spend more time outdoors- playing, making friends and being active. Let them run around in the parks and playgrounds….
  We will do more to support parents in this journey…….. "

As GWSG expands, there is a need to evolve the Message House into v.2.0- expanding to include:

- Parenting to support healthy lifestyle behaviours in the digital age, linking with stronger focus on Learn Well and Bond Well and understanding the stressors youth face with providing the necessary guidance
- Incorporating Oral Health alongside the 4 existing behaviours (Eat Well, Exercise Well, Sleep Well, Learn Well).
- Embedding the idea of 24-hour balance and behavioural interconnectedness.
- Extending guidance to youths (13–18yo) and their parents, reflecting new developmental needs.

Objectives:

1. To explore parents' resonance, interpretation, and emotional reactions to the refreshed GWSG messaging on parenting to support healthy behaviours in the digital age, and to identify areas that connect, confuse, or fail to motivate.

a. Assess how parents perceive and relate to the overarching message and key messages.
b. Understand whether parents see themselves reflected in the narrative — i.e., whether it feels relevant, realistic, and achievable.
c. Surface motivators and barriers, that triggers their emotions and actions related to supporting their children in building better healthy habits including digital well-being
d. Gather language and framing cues (words, tone, examples) that parents naturally use when talking about their own efforts to guide their children.

Narrative to Test

Healthy lifestyle and digital habits developed from young will continue into adulthood and bring long-term health and well-being. In today's digital age, parents play a critical role in guiding their child or youth to maintain a healthy balance between online and offline life and will be supported on this journey

As parents, you can:

Caa 19 Nov 2025

Key message 1	Key message 2	Key message 3
Instill healthy habits in your child early for long-term benefits.	Create a conducive home environment and take an active role to build your child's healthy habits.	You will be supported with programmes and resources to guide your child's health and digital well-being journey
Supporting messages: • It is never too late to start instilling healthy habits in your child for good health and digital well-being. Begin with small, achievable steps that your family can take together. • You are your child's best guide on purposeful screen use, online etiquette, physical activity, proper nutrition and adequate sleep – good habits take time to form, so start early, start now. • The habits* are interconnected and will improve your child's physical, mental, digital and emotional well-being, and reduce long-term health risks. • A child with healthy habits can better enjoy learning and other experiences.	**Supporting messages:** • Engage and support your child by role-modeling healthy habits. • Take charge of your family's healthy habits and routines. • Create a conducive home environment where healthy habits are communicated, developed and practiced as a family to help your child adopt healthy routines easily. • Spend quality time with your child to strengthen the parent-child relationship. Strong bonds will enable you to influence their healthy behaviours positively.	**Supporting messages:** • Your child will receive a Health Plan with actionable steps to guide them towards healthy habits. • Parenting resources and tools that are milestones/age-appropriate are readily available for you to engage and guide your child and family with. • An Enhanced School Health Support Package will be implemented in schools to reinforce your efforts at home. Support will be provided to your child based on their customised needs. • Community programmes and facilities are available to help you reinforce healthy habits in your child.

* Focus is on digital use (including screen time limits, balanced usage, content of screen use), physical activity, sleep health and healthy eating.

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2. Test resonance and practicality of HPB's current Message House CTAs and suggested ideas:

a. How parents interpret and respond to current CTAs, and what feels practical versus abstract or idealistic- is the CTA achievable? Is the CTA clear to inform parents to get the job done?
b. Assess parents' awareness to wayfind key support (i.e. resources, tools, community activities) and identify barriers preventing access
c. Assess parents' preferred formats and delivery channels (print, WhatsApp nudges, visuals, conversation starters) to inform Day 2 prototype design. (ONLY IF TIME PERMITS)
d. Identify messaging gaps and opportunities specifically linking of health behaviours with parenting values/motivators to improve message effectiveness

- Language & Tone – Capture parents' natural vocabulary to inform MH v2.0 phrasing and frontline messaging.

Methodology

- 5 in depth interviews with parents of children age range 7-9yo
- 5 in depth interviews with parents of children age range 10-12yo
- 10 in depth interviews with parents of children age range 13-18yo
- 5 in depth interviews with parents of children age range 0-2yo (priority comes last)

Screener Questions	Remarks / Objectives
• How many children do you have and what are their ages? [INTERNAL: must have a child between 0-2, 7-9, or 10-12 years old] • Can I also check your [gender], [age], [ethnicity] and [house type]?	**To recruit a balanced range of profiles on best effort basis:** **Employment mix:** Working parents (full/part-time), stay-at-home parents, single parents **Demographics:** Mixed gender, representative racial diversity **Socio-economic range:** Low to middle to high income, varied education and housing types

Note: Send the "CTAs for parents" before the IDI

Guide	Remarks / Objectives
Opening of Moderator Thank you for joining us today. I am *<moderator's name>*, and I will be moderating today's discussion. I also have some colleagues with me today who'll be helping with notetaking. The main objective of this discussion is to test some messages that HPB may use to encourage parents to cultivate of healthy behaviours for their children, in an effective manner. This is a safe space so please feel free to share your thoughts and opinions. Do note that this session will be recorded for research and notetaking purposes, but rest assured that the recording will be treated with strict confidentiality. Any views expressed will also be anonymized to protect your privacy.	
A) Introduction [5 min] 1) Please start by sharing how many children you have, and your typical weekly caregiving arrangement for your children.	To get parents to introduce their children and to

a) [If parents have preschoolers] Does your child/children go for full-day or half-day childcare? b) Who cares for your children after school on weekdays? c) Any helper or grandparents who take care of your children during the week? d) On a scale of 1 – 10, how confident are you in helping your child to practice healthy behaviours? (10 being most confidence, 0 being no confidence)	understand how their perspectives might be skewed due to their caregiving arrangement.
B) Parenting in a Digital Age [20 min] 2) What are your top concerns for your youth children apart from health (e.g., studies, mental well being etc.) In our first section, we'll be exploring Parenting in a Digital Age and 5 health behaviours. So given how technologically advanced we are now compared to even 10-20 years ago… 3) Do you think technology helps or hinders you as a parent? a) Helps in what aspects? Hinders in what aspects? b) **[Important]** In your opinion, how important is it for your child to balance between their online vs offline life? c) **[Important]** Do you think parents still play a critical role in helping them balance online/offline life <u>even when they're youths</u>? Why or why not? i) Till what age are parents the key influencer? ii) Do you think there are other stakeholders (e.g., schools) who play an important role in your child's digital well-being? 4) [Show slide on 5 health aspects] Specifically, how does technology impact the cultivation of healthy habits for your child(ren) in these 5 aspects? a) **[Important]** Do you feel it is too late to start cultivating healthy habits and ensure digital well-being for your child when they are youths? b) Do you think technology's impact on 1 aspect of health will in turn impact any other 4 areas of health? How so? 5) [Show slide of the Bond Well message] Do you resonate with this Bond Well message? Why or why not? a) So how does bonding well support and reinforce healthy lifestyles (e.g., allows you to set boundaries for healthy habits successfully)? b) What are some ways to create a conducive home environment to help you and your child bond better? 6) Are you aware of any screen / nutrition / sleep / physical activity guidelines for youths ? What are they for the 5 health aspects?	Objectives 1a-d (testing digital parenting narrative) Objectives 2a-b

a) [If yes] Can you tell me about your experiences or thoughts on the health guidelines you know of? 7) Are you aware of any community programmes/facilities to help with healthy habits and digital well-being for your child? a) Where do you usually go to find resources to help reinforce healthy habits for your child?	
C) Testing Message House CTAs [30 min] **Behaviour 1 – Screen Use [7min]** 8) [Show Message House CTAs for respective age group] **Learn Well** 1. **Role model by limiting your own screen use** when around your youth. Be **fully present** when engaging with them. 2. **Help your child navigate the online space safely** a. **Set boundaries** by guiding your child to adjust privacy settings on the social media and gaming platforms. b. **Have open, age-appropriate conversations** about appropriate content. Stay non-judgmental, check in often, and encourage your child to tell you if something feels wrong. c. **Guide your child to think before they act** to help them understand the consequences of posting inappropriate content online. d. **Encourage your child to report inappropriate content** to the relevant authorities, online platforms and/or trusted adults. a) [Go through each CTA] Is this something you are already doing? i) If yes: Has it been successful? Why or why not? *Probe: Success factors/Challenges in implementing, pain points and adaptations* (1) What were the main reasons these attempts to reduce screen time were not successful? ii) If not: Is this actionable? (1) [Yes]: How would you try to start implementing it? (2) [No]: What are the barriers to action on these CTAs? b) What suggestions do you have to make these pointers more effective or actionable for parents?	Objectives 1a-d Objectives 3a-d

i) Do you have any successful methods/tips that you personally use to reduce your child's screen time/help them use screens in a healthy way?

c) What support or resources do you know of that can help you reduce screen time for your child/help them use screens in a healthy way?

d) If you were to stand in your child's shoes for moment, which CTA do you think would excite your child most/face most resistance? And why?

Behaviour 2 – Healthy Eating [7min]

9) [Show Message 2 for respective age group]

Eat Well

1. **Provide regular, balanced meals to support your child's growth,** using My Healthy Plate for portion guidance.
2. **Make plain water the default drink.** Offer low-fat plain milk and if SSBs have to be served, choose HCS or Nutri-Grade A or B drinks to reduce sugar intake.
3. **Be a role model, taste food first** before adding salt, sauces or seasonings at the table. Guide your youth to choose lower-sodium products with HCS to reduce sodium intake.
4. **Guide your youth to make healthier eating easier at home.** Keep fruits and vegetables accessible and avoid stocking up on food and drinks high in fat, sodium and sugar.

a) [Go through each CTA] Is this something you are already doing?

i) If yes: Has it been successful? Why or why not?
Probe: Success factors/Challenges in implementing, pain points and adaptations
Probe reasons: Not understanding the guidelines fully; practical challenges to balance every meal; seeing healthy eating as costly & concerns with food expenses

(1) What were the main reasons these attempts to help your child eat healthy were not successful?

ii) If not: Is this actionable?

(1) [Yes]: How would you try to start implementing it?

(2) [No]: What are the barriers to action on these CTAs?

b) What suggestions do you have to make these pointers more effective or actionable for parents?
   i) Do you have any successful methods/tips that you personally use to help your children eat healthy?

c) What support or resources do you know of that can help your child eat healthy?

d) If you were to stand in your child's shoes for moment, which CTA do you think would excite your child most/face most resistance? And why?

Behaviour 3 – Physical Activity [7min]

10) [Show Message 3 for respective age group]

Exercise Well

1. **Find a common activity or sports** of interest to do together in a week (e.g. playing pickleball / paddle, frisbee and cycling)
2. **Role model an active lifestyle**: Show your youth how you incorporate physical activity into your routine, and invite them to exercise together.
3. **Show support** in your youth's choice of physical activity or sports (i.e. encouragement, investing in equipment and/or be their training partner)
4. **Set time** for physical activity as a part of your family routine: schedule exercise like any other priority (e.g. brushing teeth)
5. **Consider technology within limits as an option** to enable physical activity participation (e.g. Pokemon GO, virtual runs)

a) [Go through each CTA] Is this something you are already doing?
   i) If yes: Has it been successful? Why or why not?
   Probe: Success factors/Challenges in implementing, pain points and adaptations
      (1) What were the main reasons these attempts to help your child stay active were not successful?
   ii) If not: Is this actionable?
      (1) [Yes]: How would you try to start implementing it?
      (2) [No]: What are the barriers to action on these CTAs?

b) What suggestions do you have to make these more effective or actionable for parents?

Probe: Do you incorporate any family activities to encourage more physical activity?

i) Do you have any successful methods/tips that you personally use to help your children stay physically active?

c) What support or resources do you know of that can help your child engage in more physical activity?

d) If you were to stand in your child's shoes for moment, which CTA do you think would excite your child most/face most resistance? And why?

Behaviour 4 – Adequate Sleep [7min]

11) [Show Message 4 for respective age group]

Adequate Sleep

1. **Remind your teen to get sufficient sleep to recharge and have a regular sleep routine** like consistent bed and wake times, even on weekends.

2. **Encourage good sleep hygiene habits e.g. have** regular exercise, limit caffeine or late-night snacks putting devices away 1 hour before bedtime for better quality sleep

3. **Have a conducive sleep envrionment** (e.g. quiet, cool and dim) **for restful sleep.**

4. **Role model good sleep habits.**

a) [Go through each CTA] Is this something you are already doing?

i) If yes: Has it been successful? Why or why not?
Probe: Success factors/Challenges in implementing, pain points and adaptations

(1) What were the main reasons these attempts to help your child get enough sleep were not successful?

(2) When your child has to study until late, how do you support them?

ii) If not: Is this actionable?

(1) [Yes]: How would you try to start implementing it?

(2) [No]: What are the barriers to action on these CTAs?

b) What suggestions do you have to make these more effective or actionable for parents?

i) Do you have any successful methods/tips that you personally use to help your children get enough sleep?

c) What support or resources do you know of that can help your child get adequate sleep?

d) If you were to stand in your child's shoes for moment, which CTA do you think would excite your child most/face most resistance? And why?

Behaviour 5 – Oral Health

12) [Show Message 5 for respective age group]

Dental – Oral Health CTAs and Ideas for Parents

Call to action	Ideas for parents
• Brush independently once in the day and last thing at night, using a sufficiently fluoridated toothpaste (1450ppm).	• Your child may brush independently! It will still be good to occasionally check in with them to ensure that they are still brushing twice a day for 2 minutes each time.
• Regular dental visits help catch problems early and keep track of your child's risk of developing oral diseases.	• If your child is still in secondary school, you may continue to sign up for the school dental service for basic dental services (find out more about it here: https://www.healthhub.sg/programmes/school_dental_programme) • Read the Oral Health Assessment Report and practice the tips shared. • After secondary school, continue regular check-ups with your family dentist to keep your teen's smile healthy.

• Adopt tooth-friendly food and drink choices and maintain regular eating habits with three main meals and no more than 1-2 snack breaks a day.	• As your child becomes more independent with their food and drink choices, continue to guide them toward tooth-friendly options. Support them in maintaining regular eating habits by having three main meals and encouraging them to keep sweet treats to mealtimes. If snacking, remind them to limit snacking to no more than 1-2 snack breaks a day.
	• **Pick Healthier Snacks:**
	  • If your child feels hungry between meals and wants a snack, encourage them to opt for tooth-friendly snacks such as nuts or whole fruits. They may also look out for foods that have the Healthier Choice Symbol with the *"Lower in Sugar/No Added Sugar/Sugar Free"* label as a guide when purchasing their own snacks.
	• **Rinse After Eating:**
	  • Remind your child to always rinse their mouth with water after consuming food and beverages (other than water).
	• **Choose Smarter Drinks:**
	  • When they are out and about, advise your child to opt for tooth-friendly drinks such as water, or drinks that have Nutri-grade A or B as they contain low to minimal sugar. (Nutri-Grade Directory)
	  • You may also encourage your child to bring their water bottles whenever they are out. Having water on hand makes it more likely for them to choose plain water over sweetened beverages, and they can also use it to rinse their mouths after meals!

a) [Go through each CTA/idea] Is this something you are already doing?

i) If yes: Has it been successful? Why or why not?
Probe: Success factors/Challenges in implementing, pain points and adaptations

(1) What were the main reasons these attempts to help ensure your child's dental health?

ii) If not: Is this actionable?

(1) [Yes]: How would you try to start implementing it?

(2) [No]: What are the barriers to action on these CTAs?

b) What suggestions do you have to make these more effective or actionable for parents?

c) What support or resources do you know of that can help ensure your child's good oral hygiene?

d) If you were to stand in your child's shoes for moment, which CTA do you think would excite your child most/face most resistance? And why?

C) Communication Channels & Final Recommendations [5min]

13. What formats and channels would you prefer to receive guidelines/content/tips on cultivating healthy habits from your children?

Objective 3c

a) Formats – probe: Hardcopy material (e.g., pamphlets), Digital modes (e.g., WhatsApp/telegram message, **reels, AI bots, YouTube videos**) etc. b) Channels – probe: School resources/platforms, HPB social media, emails, healthcare professionals 14. As a parent, do you feel well supported by the government in providing resources for parents? a) If you could design some resources to support parents of youth like yourself to parent in a digital age, what would you include? b) Do you feel community facilities/resources are sufficient and accessible for building healthy habits and ensuring digital well-being for your child? 15. Do you have any other changes or improvements you'd like to suggest to HPB – to help parents to inculcate healthy lifestyles for their children?	
Closing We have come to the end of the discussion, thank you for your insights! Thank you again for sharing your opinions and experiences today. For the $50 PayNow token of appreciation, can I just confirm what HP number should we paynow to? Ok we will do so in 1-2 working days. That's all then, thank you once again and have a great week ahead!	